On the Optimality of Uncertain MDP Abstractions

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***Abstract*— We present an abstraction-based framework to formally control nonlinear stochastic systems under temporal logic specifications up to near-optimality. Our approach abstracts the system into an uncertain MDP and synthesizes a controller with performance guarantees via robust dynamic programming. The algorithm iteratively refines the abstraction until a near-optimality criterion is met. A thorough theoretical analysis reveals a sufficient condition guaranteeing that our algorithm terminates in finite time, namely, that refinement should reduce ambiguity in the transitions of the abstraction. We show that set-valued MDP abstractions satisfy this criterion as opposed to the interval MDP abstractions.**

I. Introduction

Automatic control of *safety-critical* cyber-physical systems requires formal guarantees, but in practice these rely on approximations with quantified (and ideally tight) error bounds. This is particularly challenging for complex, nonlinear, and stochastic robotic systems, where loose bounds (e.g., an autonomous car with safety probability lower-bound 0.90 and upper-bound 1.0) are insufficient for deployment. Abstraction-based methods address this by modeling systems as finite-state uncertain MDPs (UMDPs), enabling formal synthesis even for complex temporal logic specifications. While these approaches provide sound probability bounds, they typically lack guarantees of asymptotic optimality, i.e., that refinement of the abstraction converges to the true satisfaction probability. Indeed, finer discretizations do not always improve bounds and can even degrade them. This raises a fundamental questions: "*under what conditions are abstraction-based methods asymptotically optimal?*" In this work, we aim to address this by identifying a sufficient condition under which asymptotic optimality is guaranteed and classes of UMDP models that satisfy this condition.

When it comes to formal control via UMDP abstractions, work [1] focuses on stochastic hybrid systems with regular transition and reset kernels. It abstracts the continuous-state system as an MDP and then quantify the error between the safety probabilities of the original system and the abstraction. The obtained error bound vanishes as the discretization becomes finer, meaning that the abstraction approach is asymptotically optimal. However, the obtained bounds are loose. In consequence, [2] proposes to soundly abstract the original system into an *interval MDP* (IMDP), effectively embedding the discretization error into the abstraction. Such works obtain the tightest bounds on the transition probabilities under restrictive assumptions on the system's dynamics, like additive Gaussian disturbances and/or linear dynamics [3], [4]. Capturing the original system's dynamics more tightly than [1], these abstraction processes are also asymptotically optimal. Additional works also obtain IMDP abstractions assuming additive and/or unimodal disturbances [5]–[7]. On the other hand, when the disturbances are non-additive, most works employ 1-step reachable sets to obtain sound abstractions [8]–[11]. While these methodologies yield correct bounds in the satisfaction probabilities, it is not clear if they are asymptotically optimal.

Recent works [8], [11]–[14] employ more general UMDP abstraction classes than IMDPs to account for additional, e.g., epistemic, uncertainties [8], [12], or to obtain tighter performance bounds [11], [13], [14]. Some works also propose heuristic abstraction-refinement algorithms [4], [5], [15] in order to improve the obtained guarantees. However, a discussion on asymptotic optimality is again missing in these works. In fact, to the best of our knowledge, no UMDP abstraction-based approach ensures asymptotic optimality when considering temporal logic specifications, as the value functions become discontinuous, making convergence analysis non-trivial [1].

In this work we lay the foundation for the general theory of asymptotic optimality in UMDP abstractions under LTL_f [16] specifications. We considering a fully known system model and general rectangular UMDPs [17]. Our contributions are threefold: (i) we derive a sufficient condition on the abstraction procedure that guarantees its asymptotic optimality; (ii) we show that, for general nonlinear dynamics and when the abstraction is obtained via reach set computations state-of-the-art *set-valued MDP* (SMDP) abstractions [11], are indeed asymptotically optimal, while others, relying on the popular IMDP abstractions [10], are not; (iii) we propose a general abstraction-refinement algorithm that synthesizes ε-optimal controllers and satisfaction probability bounds in finite time for any asymptotically optimal UMDP abstraction.

II. Basic Notation

We let $\mathbb{N}_0 := \mathbb{N} \cup \{0\}$. Given a set $A \subseteq X$, we let ∂A denote the boundary of A and denote by $\mathbb{1}_A : X \mapsto \{0, 1\}$ the indicator function of A, which returns $\mathbb{1}_A(x) = 1$ if $x \in A$ and 0 otherwise. Given a subset A of a metric space (X, d), we let $\text{diam}_d(A) := \sup_{x,x' \in A} d(x, x')$ be the diameter of A. We also denote by $B(0, \epsilon) \subset X$ the closed ϵ-ball centered at 0. Given subsets $A, B \subset X$, we denote by $A \oplus B$ their *Minkowski sum*. Given a set X, we denote by $\mathcal{F}(X)$ its *Borel σ-algebra* and by $\mathcal{P}(X)$ the set of *Borel probability distributions* (measures) over X. Given a

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measurable space $(X, \mathcal{F}(X))$, we denote by $\mathcal{L}$ the *Lebesgue measure*. When the space is equipped with a metric d, we denote the *Wasserstein distance* between measures $\gamma, \gamma' \in \mathcal{P}(X)$ by $\mathcal{W}(\gamma, \gamma') := \inf_{\pi \in \Pi(\gamma,\gamma')} \int_{X^2} d(x, x') d\pi(x, x')$, where $\Pi(\gamma, \gamma') \in \mathcal{P}(X^2)$ is the set of probability measures on X^2 with marginals γ and γ'. Given a subset A of (X, d), the measurable space $(A, \mathcal{F}(A))$ and the probability measure $P \in \mathcal{P}(A)$, with a slight abuse of notation, we also interpret this measure as an element of $\mathcal{P}(X)$, without formally defining its extension on $(X, \mathcal{F}(X))$. In consequence, we sometimes write $\int_X f dP := \int_A f|_A dP$ for $f : X \to \mathbb{R}$, with $f|_A$ being the restriction of f to A.

III. Problem Formulation

We consider a discrete-time stochastic system of the form

$$x_{t+1} = f(x_t, a_t, w_t), \tag{1}$$

with $x_t \in X \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ being the state at time $t \in \mathbb{N}_0$, $a_t \in A$ denoting the action where A is a finite set, and w_t is a random disturbance. We assume that $\{w_t\}_{t \in \mathbb{N}_0}$ is an i.i.d. stochastic process taking values in a compact set $W \subset \mathbb{R}^d$, where $w_t \sim P_W$. Given $x_0, \ldots, x_T \in X$, $a_0, \ldots, u_{T-1} \in U$, and $T \in \mathbb{N}_0$, we denote a finite *trajectory* of System (1) by $\omega^X = x_0 \xrightarrow{a_0} \ldots \xrightarrow{a_{T-1}} x_T$. We let Ω_T^X denote the set of all trajectories of length $T \in \mathbb{N}_0$. A time-varying *controller* $\kappa := (\kappa_0, \ldots, \kappa_{T-1})$ is a set of functions indexed by time where each κ_t is a function $\kappa_t : \omega_t^X \to A$ that maps the current trajectory to the next action $a_t \in A$. We denote by $\mathcal{K}$ the set of all such controllers. The *transition kernel* of System (1) is a function $\mathcal{T} : \mathcal{F}(X) \times X \times A \to [0, 1]$ that, given current state x_t and action a_t, and the Borel set D, returns the probability that the successor state belongs to D, i.e., $x_{t+1} \in D$ with probability $\mathcal{T}(D \mid x, a) := \int_W \mathbb{1}_D(f(x, a, w)) dP_W(w)$.

We are interested in System (1) remaining within the safe set X_{safe} while satisfying certain temporal properties regarding a finite set of regions of interest $R := \{r_1, \ldots, r_{|R|}\}$, where $r_1, \ldots, r_{|R|-1} \subset X$ and $r_{|R|} = X \setminus X_{\text{safe}} =: X_{\text{unsafe}}$. Without loss of generality, we assume that R is a partition of X. We also consider a set of *atomic propositions* $\text{AP} := \{\mathfrak{p}_1, \ldots, \mathfrak{p}_{|\text{AP}|}\}$, and let $L : X \to 2^{\text{AP}}$ be the labeling function, which maps a state x to the set of atomic propositions that are "true" at region $r \ni x$. For example, we let $\mathfrak{p}_1 := \mathfrak{p}_{\text{safe}} \in L(x)$ for all $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$. Consequently, each trajectory $\omega_T^X = x_0 \xrightarrow{a_0} \ldots \xrightarrow{a_{T-1}} x_T$ results in the (observation) *trace* $l = l_0 \ldots l_T$, where $l_t := L(x_t)$. Formally, we consider specifications given as LTL$_f$ formulas [16] over the set AP, which are able to unambiguously characterize temporal behaviors of the system.

An LTL$_f$ formula is recursively defined as

$$\varphi := \top \mid \mathfrak{p} \mid \neg\varphi \mid \varphi_1 \wedge \varphi_2 \mid \bigcirc\varphi_1 \mid \varphi_1 \,\mathrm{U}\, \varphi_2,$$

where $\mathfrak{p} \in \text{AP}$. $\neg$ (negation) and $\wedge$ (and) are boolean operators, $\bigcirc$ (next) and U (until) are temporal operators, and φ_1 and φ_2 are LTL$_f$ formulas. From U, we define $\Diamond$ (eventually) and $\Box$ (globally) as $\Diamond\varphi \equiv \top \mathrm{U} \varphi$ and $\Box\varphi \equiv \neg\Diamond\neg\varphi$. LTL$_f$ formulae are semantically interpreted over finite traces [18]: we say that a trajectory ω^X satisfies a formula φ, i.e., $\omega^X \models \varphi$, if some prefix of its trace l satisfies φ. Specifically, we consider formulas of the form $\Box\mathfrak{p}_{\text{safe}} \wedge \varphi$, where φ is an LTL$_f$ formula. Additionally, in this work, we consider the problem of satisfying an LTL$_f$ formula in finite time.

Definition 1 (System)**.** *We refer by* the system *to the tuple* $\mathcal{S} := (X, A, W, f, P_W, R, X_{\text{safe}}, \text{AP}, L)$*. Given a controller* κ*, we denote by* $\Pr_{x_0}^{\kappa}$ *the unique probability measure [19] over the trajectories (of finite length) of* $\mathcal{S}$ *under* κ *that start at state* $x_0 \in X$*.*

Our results require the following three standard assumptions on $\mathcal{S}$:

Assumption 1. *The set* X_{safe} *is compact. Additionally,* $\mathcal{L}(\partial r) = 0$ *for all* $r \in R$*.*

Assumption 2. *For all* $x \in X$*, the conditional transition probability distribution* $\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a)$ *is continuous with respect to the Lebesgue measure, and has a conditional density* $\tau(x' \mid x, a)$ *which is bounded:* $\overline{\tau} := \sup_{x,x' \in X, a \in A} \tau(x' \mid x, a) < \infty$*.*

Assumption 3. *The vector field* f *is globally Lipschitz continuous w.r.t. its first and third arguments, i.e., there exists a constant* $L_f \geq 0$ *such that* $\|f(x, a, w) - f(x', a, w')\| \leq L_f(\|x - x'\| + \|w - w'\|)$ *for all* $x, x' \in X$*,* $w, w' \in W$*,* $a \in A$*.*

Given a controller κ, initial state $x_0 \in X$, an LTL$_f$ formula φ, and a time horizon $T \in \mathbb{N}$, we denote by $\Pr_{x_0}^{\kappa}[\varphi, T]$ the probability that the trajectory of system $\mathcal{S}$ from x_0 under κ satisfies φ within T time-steps. Similarly, we denote by $\Pr_{x_0}^{*}[\varphi, T] := \sup_{\kappa \in \mathcal{K}} \Pr_{x_0}^{\kappa}[\varphi, T]$ the optimal satisfaction probability.

In this work we consider the problem of synthesizing a controller that ensures a near-optimal satisfaction probability, and obtaining tight bounds in the satisfaction probability.

Problem 1. *Given system* $\mathcal{S}$*, an LTL*$_f$ *specification* $\varphi = \Box\mathfrak{p}_{\text{safe}} \wedge \varphi'$*, a time horizon* $T \in \mathbb{N}_0$ *and an optimality margin* $\varepsilon > 0$*, synthesize a controller* κ^{ε} *and obtain performance bounds* $\underline{p}^{\varepsilon}$ *and* $\overline{p}^{\varepsilon}$ *that ensure, for all* $x_0 \in X$*:*

(i) $|\Pr_{x_0}^{\kappa^{\varepsilon}}[\varphi, T] - \Pr_{x_0}^{*}[\varphi, T]| \leq \varepsilon$,
(ii) $\Pr_{x_0}^{\kappa^{\varepsilon}}[\varphi, T] \in [\underline{p}^{\varepsilon}(x_0), \overline{p}^{\varepsilon}(x_0)]$,
(iii) $\overline{p}^{\varepsilon}(x_0) - \underline{p}^{\varepsilon}(x_0) \leq \varepsilon$.

Overview of the Approach: We approach Problem 1 through an abstraction-refinement framework and mainly focus on analyzing the conditions under which termination is guaranteed. In this framework, at each iteration, we partition the state space and construct a UMDP abstraction of $\mathcal{S}$ that captures all relevant behaviors. We then synthesize a controller via robust dynamic programming, which also provides bounds on the satisfaction probability; thus satisfying condition (ii), as in existing UMDP-based methods [10], [11]. If the bounds meet the termination criterion, conditions (i)-(iii) are satisfied; otherwise, we refine the partition and repeat.

However, refinement does not always tighten the bounds. To address this, we introduce a sufficient condition, *ambiguity shrinkage*, under which the algorithm is *complete*, i.e., it terminates in finite time for any φ' and ε. This condition further ensures *asymptotic optimality*: as the partition becomes arbitrarily fine, all conditions in Problem 1 are satisfied with $\varepsilon = 0$. Finally, we analyze completeness for different abstractions, showing that SMDPs guarantee asymptotic optimality, whereas IMDPs do not. All the proofs are provided in the appendix of the extended version [20].

IV. Abstraction-Based Controller Design

In this section, we describe UMDP abstractions in a general way. We characterize the soundness and define the ambiguity diameter of a UMDP abstraction. Additionally, we state several standard definitions in abstraction-based controller design, such as the *deterministic finite automaton* (DFA) of an LTL_f formula, the product UMDP, the product between $\mathcal{S}$ and the DFA and the corresponding Bellman operators.

A. UMDP Abstraction

We first define the set X_{abs}, which contains X_{safe} and also its possible successor states x_{t+1} with probability 1: $X_{\text{abs}} := X_{\text{safe}} \cup \{f(x,a,w) \in X : x \in X_{\text{safe}}, a \in A, w \in W\}$. Next, we partition this set into a finite set of regions that respect the regions of interest:

Definition 2. *We say that the partition B of X_{abs} is R-respecting if, for each $b \in B$ and $r \in R$, either $b \subseteq r$ or $b \subseteq X \setminus r$. Furthermore, we let $\eta := (1/2)\max_{b\in B}\operatorname{diam}(b)$ be the* size of the partition*, and we denote the partition by $B \equiv B^\eta$.*

Given an R-respecting partition B^η of X_{abs}, we pick, for each region $b \in B$, a representative point $s \in b$ such that its distance to the boundary of b is strictly positive. We denote the set of representative points of B^η by S^η. We let S^η be the state space of the UMDP abstraction. This is slightly different from standard abstraction-based approaches, where the state space of the abstraction is simply B^η. The reason for this choice is that our approach leverages results of convergence of probability measures defined on a common space, i.e., X, which contains any S^η defined as above, but not B^η.

The partition B^η defines a *refinement function* $\rho^\eta : X_{\text{abs}} \to S^\eta$ that maps each continuous state $x \in X_{\text{abs}}$ to the representative point $s \in S^\eta$ of the region $b \in B^\eta$ that contains x. For the sake of conciseness we also write $\rho^{-\eta}(x) := b$ for each $x \in X_{\text{abs}}$, with $b \in B^\eta$ being the region x belongs to. We also partition the disturbance set W into the finite set of regions C^η, with size (diameter) at most 2η.

We now formally define a UMDP abstraction (without specifying how its transitions are obtained).

Definition 3 (UMDP)**.** *Given an R-respecting partition B^η of X_{abs}, its set of representative points S^η, and the partition C^η of W, a UMDP abstraction is a tuple $\mathcal{U}^\eta := (S^\eta, A, \Gamma^\eta, \text{AP}, L)$ where S^η is the finite state space (with $S^\eta_{\text{safe}} := S^\eta \cap X_{\text{safe}}$ denoting the safe states), A is the finite state of actions, $\Gamma^\eta := \{\Gamma^\eta_{s,a} : s \in S^\eta, a \in A\}$ with $\Gamma^\eta_{s,a} \subseteq \mathcal{P}(S^\eta)$ being the set of transition probability distributions, or ambiguity set, of state-action pair (s,a), and $L : S^\eta \to 2^{\text{AP}}$ is the labeling function*[1].

We define the *ambiguity diameter* of a UMDP abstraction as a measure of the amount of ambiguity in the UMDP below, and as we show in Section V, this quantity plays a key role when it comes to completeness of our iterative algorithm.

Definition 4 (Ambiguity Diameter)**.** *Let $\mathcal{U}^\eta := (S^\eta, A, \Gamma^\eta, \text{AP}, L)$ be a UMDP abstraction of system $\mathcal{S}$. We denote the* ambiguity diameter *of $\mathcal{U}^\eta$ by $\phi(\mathcal{U}^\eta) := \max_{s\in S^\eta_{\text{safe}}, a\in A}\operatorname{diam}_{\mathcal{W}}(\Gamma^\eta_{s,a})$, i.e., the maximum (Wasserstein) diameter of its ambiguity sets.*

Next, we discuss the semantics of UMDPs and provide the standard definitions of strategy and adversary. Given a UMDP $\mathcal{U}^\eta$, we refer by *path* of $\mathcal{U}^\eta$ of length $T \in \mathbb{N}_0$ to a sequence $\omega^\eta_T = s_0 \xrightarrow{a_0} \dots \xrightarrow{a_{T-1}} s_T$ such that $s_t \in S^\eta$ for all $0 \le t \le T$, and $a_t \in A$ for all $0 \le t \le T-1$. We denote by Ω^η_T the sets of all such paths and let $\omega^\eta_T(t)$ denote the state of a path ω^η_T at time $t \in \{0,\dots,T\}$. Analogous to a controller of $\mathcal{S}$, a *strategy* $(\sigma_t)_{t\in\{0,\dots,T-1\}}$ of $\mathcal{U}^\eta$ is a sequence of functions where each $\sigma_t : \Omega^\eta_t \to A$ chooses the next action given the path followed up to time t. We denote by Σ^η the set of all strategies of $\mathcal{U}^\eta$. When each σ_t only depends on $\omega^\eta_t(t)$, we say that σ is *Markovian* or *memoryless*. Given a finite path of length t $\omega^\eta_t \in \Omega^\eta_t$ with last state $s_t := \omega^\eta_t(t)$ and a strategy $\pi_s \in \Sigma^\eta$, $\mathcal{U}^\eta$ transitions from s_t under $a_t := \sigma_t(\omega^\eta_t)$ to s_{t+1} according to some probability distribution in $\Gamma^\eta_{s_t,a_t}$, which is chosen by the adversary [21], [22]. Formally speaking, an *adversary* is a function $\xi : S^\eta \times A \times \mathbb{N}_0 \to \mathcal{P}(S^\eta)$ that chooses, given current state s_t, action a_t and time step t, a probability distribution $\gamma \in \Gamma^\eta_{s_t,a_t}$, according to which s_{t+1} is distributed. We denote the set of all adversaries of $\mathcal{U}^\eta$ by Ξ^η. Given an initial state $s_0 \in S^\eta$, a strategy $\sigma \in \Sigma^\eta$, and an adversary $\xi \in \Xi^\eta$, $\mathcal{U}^\eta$ collapses to a Markov chain, with a unique probability measure over its finite paths. We denote this measure by $\Pr^{\sigma,\xi}_{\eta,s_0}$.

Now we formalize the notion that the UMDP abstraction captures all behaviors of interest of $\mathcal{S}$. Such abstractions ensure that the obtained controllers and satisfaction guarantees correctly translate to the original system $\mathcal{S}$.

Definition 5 (Soundness)**.** *Consider a given System $\mathcal{S}$ and its UMDP abstraction $\mathcal{U}^\eta := (S^\eta, A, \Gamma^\eta, \text{AP}, L)$. We say that $\mathcal{U}^\eta$ is a* sound abstraction *of $\mathcal{S}$ if (i) for each $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$ with $\rho^\eta(x) = s$ and $a \in A$, the distribution $\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a) \in \mathcal{P}(S^\eta)$, where $\mathcal{T}^\eta(\rho^{-\eta}(s') \mid x,a) := T(\rho^{-\eta}(s') \mid x,a)$ for all $s' \in S^\eta$, satisfies that $\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a) \in \Gamma^\eta_{s,a}$, and (ii) for each $x \notin X_{\text{safe}}$ with $\rho^\eta(x) = s$ and $a \in A$, the ambiguity set is $\Gamma^\eta_{s,a} = \{\delta_s\}$.*

Our approach assumes a given procedure of obtaining the abstraction. In consequence, the sufficient condition for com-

[1]More formally, it is the restriction of the labeling function L of $\mathcal{S}$ to S^η. With a slight abuse of language we also denote it as L

pleteness of the algorithm is a condition on the abstraction procedure. In order to keep our theoretical analysis general, we now formalize what we mean by abstraction procedure:

Definition 6 (Abstraction Procedure)**.** *Given a UMDP abstraction class $\mathbb{U}$, an LTL$_f$ formula φ and $\eta > 0$, we define an* abstraction procedure $\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}$ *as the mapping $(\mathcal{S}, \eta) \mapsto \mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)$, which soundly abstracts System $\mathcal{S}$ into a UMDP $\mathcal{U}^\eta := (S^\eta, A, \Gamma^\eta, \mathrm{AP}, L) \in \mathbb{U}$, where the size parameter of the partitions S^η and C^η is at most η.*

B. Robust Dynamic Programming

Here, we describe the standard methodology for control synthesis given a sound UMDP abstraction $\mathcal{U}$. Leveraging the fact that for each LTL$_f$ formula, a DFA can be constructed that precisely accepts the language of the formula [16], synthesis consists of four main steps: (1) obtaining the *deterministic finite automaton* (DFA) $\mathcal{A}^\varphi$ that represents φ, (2) obtaining the *product UMDP*, i.e., a different UMDP $\mathcal{U}^\varphi := \mathcal{U} \otimes \mathcal{A}^\varphi$ defined as the product between $\mathcal{U}$ and $\mathcal{A}^\varphi$, (3) performing *robust dynamic programming* (RDP) on $\mathcal{U}^\varphi$ with a reachability objective, which yields a strategy and bounds in the satisfaction probability for the product, and (4) correctly translating these results to $\mathcal{S}$.

We define the DFA of φ below.

Definition 7. *Let φ be an LTL$_f$ formula defined over* AP*. The deterministic finite automaton (DFA) constructed from φ is a tuple $\mathcal{A}^\varphi = (Z, z_{\mathrm{init}}, 2^{\mathrm{AP}}, \delta, Z_{acc})$, where Z is the finite set of states, $z_{\mathrm{init}} \in Z$ is the initial state, 2^{AP} is the alphabet (symbols), $\delta : Z \times 2^{\mathrm{AP}} \to Z$ is the deterministic transition function, and $Z_{acc} \subseteq Z$ is the set of accepting states.*

Given a trace $l = l_0 l_1 \dots l_T \in (2^{AP})^T$, a run $z = z_0 z_1 \dots z_{T+1}$ is induced on $\mathcal{A}^\varphi$, where $z_0 = z_{\mathrm{init}}$ and $z_{t+1} = \delta(z_t, l_t)$ for all $t \in \{0, \dots, T\}$. By construction of $\mathcal{A}^\varphi$, trace l satisfies φ iff it is *accepting*, i.e., iff $z_{T+1} \in Z_{\mathrm{acc}}$ [18]. Next, we define the product between System $\mathcal{S}$ and $\mathcal{A}^\varphi$, whose transitions carry information about both the dynamics of $\mathcal{S}$ and satisfaction of φ.

Definition 8 (Product MDP)**.** *Let $\mathcal{A}^\varphi = (Z, z_{\mathrm{init}}, 2^{\mathrm{AP}}, \delta, Z_{acc})$ be the DFA corresponding to φ. The product $\mathcal{S}^\varphi := \mathcal{S} \otimes \mathcal{A}^\varphi$ is an MDP $\mathcal{S}^\varphi := (X^\varphi, A, \mathcal{T}^\varphi, \mathrm{AP}, L^\varphi)$ over the hybrid space $X^\varphi = X \times Z$, with labeling function $L^\varphi(x, z) := L(x)$ for all $(x, z) \in X^\varphi$ and transition kernel $\mathcal{T}^\varphi$ defined as*

$$\mathcal{T}^\varphi(D \times \{z'\} \mid (x, z)) = \mathcal{T}(\{x' \in D : z' = \delta(z, L(x'))\}),$$

for all $x \in X$, $D \in \mathcal{F}(X)$, $z, z' \in Z$.

We note that, since we consider specifications that require the system to remain in X_{safe}, $\mathcal{A}^\varphi$ always has an absorbing state $z_{\mathrm{unsafe}} \in Z$ that is reached when the label of the successor state x' does not contain $\mathfrak{p}_{\mathrm{safe}}$. Once a trajectory of $\mathcal{S}^\varphi$ reaches this state, φ cannot be satisfied. We next define the product UMDP.

Definition 9 (Product UMDP)**.** *Given a UMDP $\mathcal{U}$ and the DFA $\mathcal{A}^\varphi$, we define the* product UMDP *$\mathcal{U}^\varphi := \mathcal{U} \otimes \mathcal{A}^\varphi$ as the UMDP $\mathcal{U}^\varphi := (S^\varphi, A, \Gamma^\varphi, \mathrm{AP}, L^\varphi)$, where $S^\varphi := S \times Z$, $L^\varphi(x, z) = L(x)$ for all $X \in X$ and $z \in Z$, and $\Gamma^\varphi := \{\Gamma^\varphi_{(s,z),a} : (s, z) \in S^\varphi, a \in A\} \subset \mathcal{P}(S^\varphi)$, with*

$$\Gamma^\varphi_{(s,z),a} := \Big\{\gamma^\varphi \in \mathcal{P}(S^\varphi) : \gamma^\varphi(s', \delta(z, L(s'))) = \gamma(s')\ ,\ \gamma \in \Gamma_{s,a}, s' \in S\Big\}, \quad (2)$$

for all $X \in X$ and $z \in Z$.

The products $\mathcal{S}^\varphi$ and $\mathcal{U}^\varphi$ enable characterizing optimal controllers and satisfaction probabilities through RDP, which boils down to probabilistic reachability computations on the products. We next define the *Bellman operator* of the product $\mathcal{S}^\varphi$, which appears in the RDP iterations:

Definition 10 (Bellman Operator)**.** *Consider the product MDP $\mathcal{S}^\varphi$ of $\mathcal{S}$ with the DFA $\mathcal{A}^\varphi$. Denote by $\mathcal{V}^\varphi$ the set of value functions on X^φ, i.e., $\mathcal{V}^\varphi := \{v : X^\varphi \to [0, 1]\}$. Given a value function v the Bellman operator $\mathcal{B} : \mathcal{V}^\varphi \to \mathcal{V}^\varphi$ of $\mathcal{S}^\varphi$ is defined as $\mathcal{B}[v](x, z) = \max_{a \in A} \mathcal{B}_a[v](x, z)$, with*

$$\mathcal{B}_a[v](x, z) := \mathbb{1}_{Z_{acc}}(z) + \mathbb{1}_{Z \setminus Z_{acc}}(z) \int_{X^\varphi} v d\mathcal{T}^\varphi(\cdot \mid (x, z), a)$$
$$= \mathbb{1}_{Z_{acc}}(z) + \mathbb{1}_{Z \setminus Z_{acc}}(z) \int_X v(x', \delta(z, L(x')))\mathcal{T}(dx' \mid x, a),$$

for all $x \in X$ and $z \in Z$.

In analogy with the previous definition, we now define the Bellman operators of the product UMDP $\mathcal{U}^{\eta,\varphi}$.

Definition 11 (Ambiguous Bellman Operators)**.** *Consider a UMDP abstraction $\mathcal{U}^\eta$ of $\mathcal{S}$ and its product $\mathcal{U}^\varphi$ with $\mathcal{A}^\varphi$. For each $v \in \mathcal{V}^\varphi$ and $z \in Z$, denote by $v^\eta \in \mathcal{V}^\varphi$ the tightest piecewise constant minorizer of v on the partition B^η, i.e., the value function satisfying $v^\eta(x, z) := \inf\{v(y, z) : y \in X_{abs}, \rho^\eta(x) = \rho^\eta(y)\}$ for $x \in X_{abs}$ and $v^\eta(x, z) = 0$ elsewhere. We denote by $\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta, \overline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta : \mathcal{V}^\varphi \to \mathcal{V}^\varphi$ (respectively) the* pessimistic *and* optimistic *Bellman operators, defined as $\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[\cdot](x, z) := \max_{a \in A} \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[\cdot](x, z)$ and $\overline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[\cdot](x, z) := \max_{a \in A} \overline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[\cdot](x, z)$ for all $x \in X_{\mathrm{safe}}$ and $z \in Z$, with*

$$\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v](x, z) := \mathbb{1}_{Z_{acc}}(z) + \mathbb{1}_{Z \setminus Z_{acc}}(z) \min_{\gamma \in \Gamma^{\eta,\varphi}_{(s,z),a}} \int_{X^\varphi} v^\eta d\gamma$$
$$= \mathbb{1}_{Z_{acc}}(z) + \mathbb{1}_{Z \setminus Z_{acc}}(z) \min_{\gamma \in \Gamma^\eta_{s,a}} \int_X v^\eta(\cdot, \delta(z, L(\cdot)))d\gamma,$$

and

$$\overline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v](x, z) := \mathbb{1}_{Z_{acc}}(z) + \mathbb{1}_{Z \setminus Z_{acc}}(z) \max_{\gamma \in \Gamma^{\eta,\varphi}_{(s,z),a}} \int_{X^\varphi} v^\eta d\gamma$$
$$= \mathbb{1}_{Z_{acc}}(z) + \mathbb{1}_{Z \setminus Z_{acc}}(z) \max_{\gamma \in \Gamma^\eta_{s,a}} \int_X v^\eta(\cdot, \delta(z, L(\cdot)))d\gamma$$

for each $x \in X_{\mathrm{safe}}$ with $s = \rho(x)$, $z \in Z$ and $a \in A$. We also define $\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v](x, z) = \overline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v](x, z) := 0$ for all $x \notin X_{\mathrm{safe}}$ and $z \in Z$.

Given the products $\mathcal{S}^\varphi$ and $\mathcal{U}^{\eta,\varphi}$, we next describe how RDP is performed on them. While RDP on $\mathcal{U}^{\eta,\varphi}$ is the

actual algorithm that is implemented, yielding a controller and bounds in the probability of satisfying φ, RDP on $\mathcal{S}^\varphi$ is a mere mathematical tool that enables reasoning about the correctness of the controller and the satisfaction probability bounds.

Proposition 1 (RDP)**.** *Consider system $\mathcal{S}$ and its UMDP abstraction $\mathcal{U}^\eta := (S^\eta, A, \Gamma^\eta, \mathrm{AP}, L)$, as well as the products $\mathcal{S}^\varphi$ and $\mathcal{U}^{\eta,\varphi}$ with the DFA $\mathcal{A}^\varphi$. Define the sequence of* pessimistic *value functions $(\underline{v}_k)_{k\leq T} \subset \mathcal{V}^\varphi$ satisfying $\underline{v}_0 = \mathbb{1}_{X^\varphi_{acc}}$ and $\underline{v}_{k+1} = \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[\underline{v}_k]$, for all $k \leq T$. Define $\underline{p}^\eta(x_0) = \underline{v}_T(x_0, \delta(z, L(z_{\mathrm{init}})))$. Then [12],*

- $\underline{p}^\eta(x_0) = \sup_{\sigma\in\Sigma^{\eta,\varphi}} \inf_{\xi\in\Xi^{\eta,\varphi}} \Pr^{\sigma,\xi}_{\eta,s_0}[\varphi, T]$, *with $s_0 = \rho(x_0)$, for all $x_0 \in X_{abs}$.*

Similarly, let $(\overline{v}_k)_{k\leq T} \subset \mathcal{V}^\varphi$ denote the optimistic *sequence satisfying $\overline{v}_0 = \mathbb{1}_{X^\varphi_{acc}}$ and $\overline{v}_{k+1} = \overline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[\overline{v}_k]$, for all $k \leq T$. Define $\overline{p}^\eta(x_0) = \overline{v}_T(x_0, \delta(z, L(z_{\mathrm{init}})))$ for all $x_0 \in X$. Then [12],*

- $\overline{p}^\eta(x_0) = \sup_{\sigma\in\Sigma^{\eta,\varphi}} \sup_{\xi\in\Xi^{\eta,\varphi}} \Pr^{\sigma,\xi}_{\eta,s_0}[\varphi, T]$, *with $s_0 = \rho(x_0)$, for all $x_0 \in X_{abs}$.*

Define the sequence of value functions $(v_k)_{k\leq T} \subset \mathcal{V}^\varphi$ satisfying $v_0 = \mathbb{1}_{X^\varphi_{acc}}$ and $v_{k+1} = \mathcal{B}[v_k]$ for all $k \leq T$. Define $p(x_0) = v_T(x_0, \delta(z, L(z_{\mathrm{init}})))$ for all $x_0 \in X$. Then [19],

- $p(x_0) = \Pr^*_{x_0}[\varphi, T]$ *for all $x_0 \in X$.*

Define a Markovian strategy $\sigma^{\eta,\varphi} \in \Sigma^{\eta,\varphi}$ such that $\sigma^{\eta,\varphi}_t(s, z) \in \arg\max_{a\in A} \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[\underline{v}^\eta_{T-t-1}](s, z)$ for each $t \in \{0, \ldots, T-1\}$, $s \in S^\eta$ and $z \in Z$. Map $\sigma^{\eta,\varphi}$ to the controller κ^η of $\mathcal{S}$ by defining $\kappa^\eta(\omega^X_t) := \sigma^{\eta,\varphi}(\omega^{\eta,\varphi}_t(t))$, where $\omega^{\eta,\varphi}_t \in \Omega^{\eta,\varphi}_t$ is the path of $\mathcal{U}^{\eta,\varphi}$ generated by path $\omega^X_t \in \Omega^X_t$ of $\mathcal{S}$. Then [23],

- $\Pr^{\kappa^\eta}_{x_0}[\varphi, T] = [\underline{p}^\eta(x_0), \overline{p}^\eta(x_0)]$ *for $x_0 \in X_{abs}$,*

and [24],

- $\Pr^*_{x_0}[\varphi, T] = [\underline{p}^\eta(x_0), \overline{p}^\eta(x_0)]$ *for $x_0 \in X_{abs}$.*

Now we formally define asymptotic optimality of a UMDP abstraction procedure.

Definition 12 (Asymptotic Optimality)**.** *Consider the abstraction procedure $\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}$ and let $(\underline{p}^\eta, \overline{p}^\eta, \kappa^\eta)$ be the result of running RDP on $\mathcal{U}^\eta = \mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)$, for $\eta > 0$. We say that the abstraction procedure $\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}$ is asymptotically optimal if for each LTL$_f$ formula φ and horizon $T \in \mathbb{N}_0$ it holds that $P^{\kappa^\eta}_\cdot[\varphi, T]$, $\underline{p}^\eta_T$, and $\overline{p}^\eta_T$ uniformly converge to $P^*_\cdot[\varphi, T]$ as $\eta \to 0$.*

V. Algorithm for Near-Optimal Control

In this section we present Algorithm 1 to solve Problem 1, and a sufficient condition on the abstraction procedure that ensures completeness of the algorithm, i.e., that it successfully terminates in finite time. Our algorithm soundly abstracts $\mathcal{S}$ into a UMDP abstraction for a partition that is iteratively refined. At each iteration, the algorithm obtains a strategy for the abstraction and bounds in the probability of satisfying the specification through RDP on the abstraction. If the gap between the bounds is smaller than some user-defined $\varepsilon > 0$, then the algorithm stops, ensuring that the synthesized controller is ε-optimal, i.e., that it solves Problem 1. We now state six lemmas which enable us to find a sufficient condition for asymptotic optimality of a function class (Theorem 1). Proofs are provided in Appendix. The following lemma states that, when the current state x_t of $\mathcal{S}$ is perturbed to some y, the magnitude of the perturbation controls the variation in the expected value of a uniformly continuous function at state x_{t+1}.

Algorithm 1 ε-Optimal Control Synthesis

Require: $\mathcal{S}, \varphi, T, \varepsilon, \mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}, (\eta_i)_{i\in\mathbb{N}}$ such that $\eta_i > 0$, $\eta_i > \eta_{i+1}$ and $\lim_{i\to\infty} \eta_i = 0$
Ensure: ϵ-optimal controller κ^ϵ, $\underline{p}^\epsilon, \overline{p}^\epsilon$

```
Compute A from φ
i ← 0
while max{p̄(x) − p̲(x) | x ∈ X} > ε do
    i ← i + 1
    U ← Abs_U(S, η_i)
    Obtain p̲, p̄ and σ^φ via RDP on U ⊗ A_φ
κ^ε ← refine σ^φ to S
(p̲^ε, p̄^ε) ← (p̲, p̄)
```

Lemma 1. *Let Assumptions 2 and 3 hold and $v \in \mathcal{V} := \{v : X \to [0, 1]\}$ be uniformly continuous with $\mu : [0, \infty) \to [0, \infty)$ being a concave and non-decreasing modulus of continuity of v. Then, for all $x, y \in X$ and $a \in A$, it holds that*

$$\left|\int_X v d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a) - \int_X v d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid y, a)\right| \leq \mu(\mathcal{W}(\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a), \mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid y, a))) \leq \mu(L_f \|x - y\|).$$

Lemma 2 establishes uniform continuity of the value functions of $\mathcal{S}^\varphi$.

Lemma 2. *Consider the value functions $(v_k)_{k\leq T}$ of $\mathcal{S}^\varphi$ in Proposition 1. If Assumptions 1 and 2 hold, then the functions $v_0(\cdot, z), \ldots, v_T(\cdot, z)$ are uniformly continuous on X for all $z \in Z$.*

The following lemma characterizes convergence of the expected value of uniformly continuous functions of the successor state of $\mathcal{U}^{\eta,\varphi}$ as the partitions are refined.

Lemma 3. *Assume that $\lim_{\eta\to 0} \phi(\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)) = 0$, where $\phi(\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta))$ is the ambiguity diameter of the UMDP $\mathcal{U}^\eta = \mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)$ (see Definition 4). Let $v \in \mathcal{V}^\varphi$, with $v(\cdot, z')$ being uniformly continuous on X for all $z \in Z$, and define $v_z := v(\cdot, \delta(z, L(\cdot)))$ for all $z \in Z$. Further, for each $x \in X_{\mathrm{safe}}$, $a \in A$ and $\eta > 0$, let $\gamma^\eta_{x,a} \in \Gamma^\eta_{s,a}$, with $s = \rho(x)$. Then it holds that, for each $z \in Z$ and $a \in A$,*

$$\lim_{\eta\to 0} \left|\int_X v_z d\gamma^\eta_{x,a} - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x, a)\right| = 0$$

uniformly on $x \in X_{\mathrm{safe}}$.

Intuitively, Lemma 3 states that fine partitions and a vanishing ambiguity diameter guarantees that the ambiguity in the transitions of $\mathcal{U}^\eta$ has small effect on the expected value of uniformly continuous functions when compared with

expectations taken with respect to $\mathcal{T}^\eta$. More importantly, it guarantees that the convergence is uniform in $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$.

The following lemma gives a similar uniform convergence result but comparing the expectations taken with respect to $\mathcal{T}^\eta$ and $\mathcal{T}$, thus quantifying the error introduced by discretizing the transition kernel:

Lemma 4. *Let v_z be as defined in Lemma 3 for each $z \in Z$. Then, it holds that, for each $z \in Z$ and $a \in A$,*

$$\lim_{\eta \to 0} \left| \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x, a) - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a) \right| = 0$$

uniformly on $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$.

The next lemma shows that fine partitions and a shrinking ambiguity diameter guarantee that the Bellman operators $\mathcal{B}$ and $\mathcal{B}^\eta$ yield similar outputs for uniformly continuous input functions that are identically zero if $z = z_{\text{unsafe}}$. The lemma also shows that the difference in said outputs vanishes, uniformly on $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$, as the partitions are refined.

Lemma 5. *Let $v \in \mathcal{V}^\varphi$ with $v(\cdot, z_{unsafe}) = 0$, and $v(\cdot, z)$ be uniformly continuous on X for all $z \in Z$. Assume that $\lim_{\eta \to 0} \phi(\text{Abs}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)) = 0$. Then, for each $z \in Z$,*

$$\lim_{\eta \to 0} |\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v](x, z) - \mathcal{B}[v](x, z)| = 0$$

uniformly on $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$.

Intuitively, Lemma 4 quantifies the 1-step error due to the conservatism in the abstraction, showing that it vanishes as the partitions are refined.

Lemma 6. *Let $v, v' \in \mathcal{V}^\varphi$ with $v(\cdot, z_{unsafe}) = v'(\cdot, z_{unsafe}) = 0$. Then,*

$$\sup_{x \in X_{\text{safe}}, z \in Z} |\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v](x, z) - \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v'](x, z)| \leq \sup_{x \in X_{\text{safe}}, z \in Z} |v^\eta(x, z) - v'^\eta(x, z)|.$$

We now formally state our main results regarding optimality and completeness.

Theorem 1 (Asymptotic Optimality)**.** *Consider a given system $\mathcal{S}$ and the abstraction procedure $\text{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}$. Then, $\text{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}$ is asymptotically optimal if $\lim_{\eta \to 0} \phi(\text{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)) = 0$, i.e., if the ambiguity in the UMDP $\mathcal{U}^\eta = \text{Abs}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)$ vanishes with η.*

The following corollary is a direct result of Theorem 1.

Corollary 1 (Completeness of Algorithm 1)**.** *Consider a given system $\mathcal{S}$ and abstraction procedure $\text{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}$. If $\text{Abs}_{\mathbb{U}}$ is asymptotically optimal, then Algorithm 1 solves Problem 1 in* finite time *for any LTL$_f$ formula φ, horizon $T \in \mathbb{N}_0$, and $\varepsilon > 0$.*

We highlight the generality of Theorem 1 and Corollary 1, as they do not impose restrictive assumptions on the partitions or discretization scheme: only that the partitions must be R-respecting and that $(\eta_i)_{i \in \mathbb{N}}$ must decrease monotonously to 0 (see Algorithm 1), i.e., the size of each region in the partition vanishes in the limit. For example, one could choose the shape of S^{η_i} in an adaptive way, namely, depending on $S^{\eta_{i-1}}$ and on the results of iteration $i - 1$.

Remark 1. *Determining whether or not the* sufficient *condition in Theorem 1 is also* necessary *for asymptotic optimality of Algorithm 1 is not straightforward, as our proofs employ several overapproximations and. Furthermore, our definition of asymptotic optimality in Definition 12 requires the abstraction procedure to yield, in the limit as $\eta \to 0$ and via RDP, optimal results for every LTL$_f$ property. In consequence, we do not rule out the possibility that there may exist some LTL$_f$ property and an abstraction procedure that yield an optimal controller as $\eta \to 0$ and/or that Algorithm 1 returns a ε-optimal controller for some $\varepsilon > 0$. However, we highlight the importance of designing an abstraction procedure that is guaranteed to provide ε-optimal results for every LTL$_f$ formula and $\varepsilon > 0$. Otherwise, it is not clear if a non-asymptotically optimal procedure will work for the formula and ε of interest.*

VI. Common UMDP Abstractions

In this section, we examine common UMDP abstraction procedures, namely, SMDP and IMDP abstraction via reachability computations, and study their behavior as the partition is refined. We show that, while these SMDPs are asymptotically optimal, IMDPs (obtained as per [10]) are not. We highlight that our conclusions apply to the specific procedure of obtaining IMDP and SMDP abstractions, and provide no claim towards optimality of the abstraction class, as different abstraction procedures may lead to different optimality features.

We first define the 1-step reachable set of regions $b \subseteq X$ and $c \subseteq W$ under action $a \in A$ as the set

$$\mathcal{R}(b, a, c) := \{f(x, a, w) \in X : x \in b, w \in c\}.$$

A. SMDPs

An SMDP $\mathcal{U}^{\mathbb{S}}$ is a UMDP class whose ambiguity set $\Gamma^{\mathbb{S}}$ has the following structure [11]: each probability distribution $\gamma \in \Gamma^{\mathbb{S}}$ corresponds to transitioning to a set of states (or *cluster*) with a given probability, and the actual successor state inside that cluster being distributed according to some conditional probability distribution. In consequence, given a conditional probability distribution for each cluster, a distribution $\gamma \in \Gamma^{\mathbb{S}}$ is identified. Therefore, the ambiguity in the transitions of $\mathcal{U}^{\mathbb{S}}$ comes from allowing the conditional distributions to take any value within the corresponding probability simplices. In the following definition we formalize this intuition and show how to compute the clusters of the SMDP abstraction.

Definition 13 (SMDP Abstraction [11])**.** *Consider System $\mathcal{S}$, the R-respecting partition B^η and the partition C^η of W. For all $s \in S^\eta_{\text{safe}}$, $a \in A$, $c \in C^\eta$, define cluster $q_{s,a,c} := S^\eta \cap \mathcal{R}(\rho^{-1}(s), a, c)$, and let $Q^\eta_{s,a} := \{q_{s,a,c} : c \in C^\eta\}$. For each $q_{s,a,c} \in Q^\eta_{s,a}$, let $\theta_{s,a,c} \in \mathcal{P}(q_{s,a,c})$. For each*

$$\theta_{s,a} := \left(\theta_{s,a,c}\right)_{c \in C^\eta} \in \bigtimes_{c \in C^\eta} \mathcal{P}(q_{s,a,c}) =: \Theta^\eta_{s,a},$$

denote $\gamma_{\theta_{s,a}} \in \mathcal{P}(S^\eta)$ the probability distribution such that

$$\gamma_{\theta_{s,a}}(s') = \sum_{c \in C^\eta : s' \in q_{s,a,c}} \theta_{s,a,c}(s') P_W(c), \tag{3}$$

for $s' \in S^\eta$. We define the SMDP abstraction of System $\mathcal{S}$ as $\mathcal{U}^{\mathbb{S},\eta} := (S^\eta, A, \Gamma^{\mathbb{S},\eta}, \mathrm{AP}, L)$, where

$$\Gamma^{\mathbb{S},\eta}_{s,a} := \{\gamma_{\theta_{s,a}} : \theta_{s,a} \in \Theta_{s,a}\} \qquad \forall s \in S^\eta_{\text{safe}},\ a \in A, \tag{4}$$

and $\Gamma^{\mathbb{S},\eta}_{s,a} := \{\delta_s\}$ for all $s \notin S^\eta_{\text{safe}}$ and $a \in A$.

As shown in [11], such an SMDP abstraction is Sound as per Definition 5. The following theorem establishes optimality of such an abstraction process.

Theorem 2. *Let $\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{S}}$ be the abstraction procedure that abstracts $\mathcal{S}$ into an SMDP as per Definition 13. Then,*

- $\lim_{\eta \to 0} \phi(\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{S}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)) = 0$,
- $\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{S}}$ *is asymptotically optimal,*
- *Algorithm 1 and* $\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{S}}$ *solve Problem 1 in finite time.*

The proof of Theorem 2 first shows that the first item in the theorem holds. This implies that Theorem 1 and Corollary 1 also hold, proving the second and third items. In order to show that $\phi(\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{S}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)) \to 0$, the proof first bounds the Wasserstein distance between conditional distributions on each cluster $q_{s,a,c}$ of $\mathcal{U}^{\mathbb{S},\eta} = \mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{S}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)$. The bounds for all clusters are then combined to obtain a bound on the ambiguity diameter $\phi(\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{S}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta))$, which is then shown to vanish with η, as the diameters of the clusters $q_{s,a,c}$ shrink when the partitions S^η and C^η are refined.

SMDP Abstraction with Reduced Complexity: We now note that, when abstracting System $\mathcal{S}$ to an SMDP, there is no need to partition the entirety of set X_{abs}, but only the safe set X_{safe}. This is made possible by treating X_{unsafe} as a single unsafe set in B^η, whose representative point is some $s_{\text{unsafe}} \in X_{\text{unsafe}}$. This reduces the size of the abstraction, alleviating memory and computational complexity. In the following theorem we show that performing RDP on such an SMDP yields the same results as on an SMDP as per Definition 13, i.e., the same controller and performance bounds.

Theorem 3 (SMDP Abstraction with Smaller Partition)**.** *Consider System $\mathcal{S}$, the R-respecting partition B^η and the partition C^η of W. Let $\widetilde{B}^\eta := \big(\cup_{b \in B^\eta : b \subseteq X_{\text{safe}}} \{b\}\big) \cup \{X_{unsafe}\}$, $\widetilde{S}^\eta := \big(S^\eta \cap X_{\text{safe}}\big) \cup \{s_{unsafe}\}$, with s_{unsafe} being the representative point of the region X_{unsafe} Let $\tilde{\rho}$ be the same as ρ for states $s \in X_{\text{safe}}$, $\tilde{\rho}^\eta(x) = s_{unsafe}$ for all $x \in X_{unsafe}$ and $\tilde{\rho}^{-\eta}(s_{unsafe}) = X_{unsafe}$. Define the abstraction function $\widetilde{\mathrm{Abs}}_{\mathbb{S}}$ that abstracts System $\mathcal{S}$ into the SMDP $\widetilde{\mathcal{U}}^{\mathbb{S},\eta} := (\widetilde{S}^\eta, A, \widetilde{\Gamma}^{\mathbb{S},\eta}, \mathrm{AP}, \widetilde{L})$ as per Definition 13, but using the sets $\widetilde{S}^\eta$ and $\widetilde{B}^\eta$ and the function $\tilde{\rho}$ defined here. Then,*

- $\widetilde{\mathrm{Abs}}_{\mathbb{S}}$ *is asymptotically optimal,*
- *Algorithm 1 and* $\widetilde{\mathrm{Abs}}_{\mathbb{S}}$ *solve Problem 1 in finite time.*

B. IMDPs

An IMDP $\mathcal{U}^{\mathbb{I}}$ is a UMDP class whose ambiguity set $\Gamma^{\mathbb{S}}$ constrains the probability of transitioning to each state by an interval. In the following definition we describe the IMDP abstraction procedure of [10].

Definition 14 (IMDP Abstraction [10])**.** *Consider System $\mathcal{S}$, the R-respecting partition B^η and the partition C^η of W. For each $(s, a, s') \in S^\eta_{\text{safe}} \times A \times S^\eta$, let*

$$\begin{aligned}
&\underline{P}^\eta(s, a, s') \\
&:= \sum_{c \in C^\eta} P_W(c) \mathbf{1}\Big(\mathcal{R}(\rho^{-\eta}(s), a, c) \subseteq \rho^{-\eta}(s')\Big), \\
&\overline{P}^\eta(s, a, s') \\
&:= \sum_{c \in C^\eta} P_W(c) \mathbf{1}\Big(\mathcal{R}(\rho^{-\eta}(s), a, c) \cap \rho^{-\eta}(s') \neq \emptyset\Big),
\end{aligned}$$

where $\mathbf{1}$ returns 1 if its argument is true and 0 otherwise. We define the Interval MDP *(IMDP) abstraction of System $\mathcal{S}$ as the tuple $\mathcal{U}^{\mathbb{I},\eta} = (S^\eta, A, \Gamma^{\mathbb{I},\eta}, \mathrm{AP}, L)$, where*

$$\begin{aligned}
\Gamma^{\mathbb{I},\eta}_{s,a} := \big\{\gamma \in \mathcal{P}(S^\eta) : \forall s' \in S^\eta, \\
\underline{P}^\eta(s, a, s') \leq \sum_{s' \in S^\eta} \gamma(s') \leq \overline{P}^\eta(s, a, s')\big\}
\end{aligned} \tag{5}$$

for all $s \in S^\eta_{\text{safe}}$ and $a \in A$, and $\Gamma^{\mathbb{I},\eta}_{s,a} := \{\delta_s\}$ for all $s \notin S^\eta_{\text{safe}}$ for all $a \in A$.

[10] proves that such an IMDP abstraction is Sound as per Definition 5. The following theorem shows that this abstraction procedure might fail under very mild assumptions.

Theorem 4. *Consider the abstraction procedure $\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{I}}$ that abstracts $\mathcal{S}$ into an IMDP via a uniform partition and let $A = \{a\}$. Assume that f is not one-step contractive, namely, there exist a set $X_0 \subset X_{\text{safe}}$ and $w \in W$ such that $\mathrm{diam}(\mathcal{R}(X_0, a, \{w\})) > \mathrm{diam}(X_0)$. Then,*

- $\lim_{\eta \to 0} \phi(\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{I}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)) \neq 0$,
- $\mathrm{Abs}_{\mathbb{I}}$ *is not asymptotically optimal,*
- *There exists a specification φ and $\varepsilon > 0$ for which Algorithm 1 does not solve Problem 1.*

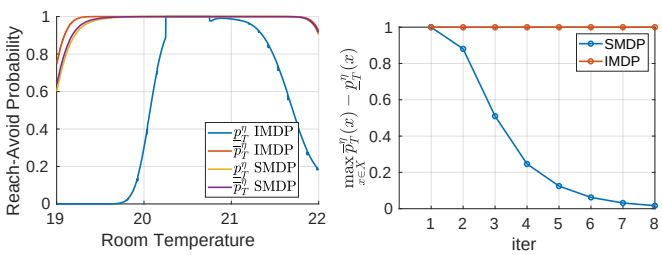
The proof is by counterexample. We show that for specific system dynamics and a simple reach-avoid specification, strategy synthesis on the IMDP abstraction yields trivial bounds, i.e., $\underline{p}_1(x_0) = 0$ and $\overline{p}_1(x_0) = 1$ in the probability of satisfying the specification for some state x_0. We show that these bounds cannot be tightened by refining the partitions.

We note that, even though it is common practice to employ partitions of different granularities, adapting Theorem 4 to consider such partitions becomes challenging. However, we highlight that the key phenomenon in the proof of the theorem, i.e., some reachable sets intersecting more than one region in the partition, would still happen in that case, thus providing evidence that the theorem extends to such partitions.

VII. Empirical Validation

We validate our theoretical results through two case studies: a 1-dimensional temperature regulation benchmark with a reach-avoid goal and a 2-dimensional nonlinear cart model

with an LTL$_f$ specification. The temperature regulation system is given in [25], and its results are shown in Figure 1, where we compare the bounds in the satisfaction probabilities of SMDPs and IMDPs. The goal is to regulate the system's temperature to the interval $[21.25, 20.75]$ under $T = 20$ steps while staying within the bounds $[19, 22]$. Figure 1(b) shows the iterations of Algorithm 1, plotting the termination criterion for IMDP and SMDP abstractions as a function of the iteration number. As expected, while the SMDP-based approach asymptotically converges to 0, shrinking the error bound within 2% in 8 iterations, the results of the IMDP approach do not improve via refinement. Figure 1(a) shows the bounds in the satisfaction probability for the 8th iteration, with $|S^\eta| = 1280$ and $|C^\eta| = 256$.



(a) (b)

Fig. 1: Temperature regulation benchmark: (a) Lower and upper bounds in the satisfaction probabilities for fixed discretization. (b) Gap in the satisfaction probability bounds v.s. iteration number in Algorithm 1

For further illustrations, we also studied a 2D system with nonlinear model of a cart under an LTL$_f$ specification taken from [26]. The results show similar trends as in 1D. The details of the results are shown and discussed in the extended version [20].

Appendix

Proof of Lemma 1. Pick $x, y \in X$, $a \in A$ and a coupling $\pi \in \arg\min_{\pi\in\Pi(\mathcal{T}(\cdot|x,a),\mathcal{T}(\cdot|y,a))} \int_{X\times X} \|x' - y'\| d\pi(x', y')$. Then, it holds that $|\int_X v d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid a, x) - \int_X v d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid a, y)| = |\int_{X\times X} v(x') d\pi(x', y') - \int_{X\times X} v(y') d\pi(x', y')| \leq |\int_{X\times X}(v(x') - v(y')) d\pi(x', y')| \leq \int_{X\times X} |v(x') - v(y')| d\pi(x', y') \leq \int_{X\times X} \mu(\|x' - y'\|) d\pi(x', y')$. By Jensen's inequality, the previous expression is bounded by $\mu(\int_{X\times X} \|x' - y'\| d\pi(x', y')) = \mu(\mathcal{W}(\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a), \mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid y, a)))$. Standard results on Wasserstein distances give [27] $\mathcal{W}(\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a), \mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid y, a)) \leq L_f \|x - y\|$, which concludes the proof. □

Proof of Lemma 2. We proceed by induction. Assume that $v_k(\cdot, z)$ is uniformly continuous on X for each z, which is trivially satisfied at $k = 0$. We want to prove uniform continuity of v_{k+1}. Let $x, y \in X$ and $z \in Z$, and note that

$$\begin{aligned}|v_{k+1}(x, z) - v_{k+1}(y, z)| &= |\mathcal{B}[v_k](x, z) - \mathcal{B}[v_k](y, z)| \\ &= |\max_{a\in A} \mathcal{B}_a[v_k](x, z) - \max_{a\in A} \mathcal{B}_a[v_k](y, z)|\end{aligned}$$

Let $a^* \in \arg\max\{\mathcal{B}_a[v_k](x, z) : a \in A\}$. Then,

$$\begin{aligned}&|\max_{a\in A} \mathcal{B}_a[v_k](x, z) - \max_{a\in A} \mathcal{B}_a[v_k](x, z)| \\ &\quad\leq |B^\varphi_{a^*}[v_k](x, z) - B^\varphi_{a^*}[v_k](x, z)| \\ &\quad\leq \max_{a\in A} |\mathcal{B}_a[v_k](x, z) - \mathcal{B}_a[v_k](x, z)|.\end{aligned}$$

Next, we bound the right-hand side. Let $D_\epsilon := \left(\cup_{r\in R} \partial r\right) \oplus B(0, \epsilon)$ be the ϵ-thickening of the zero-measure set $\cup_{r\in R}\partial r$. Fix $z \in Z$ and note that $v_z := v_k(\cdot, \delta(z, L(\cdot))) \in \mathcal{V}$ is uniformly continuous on each $r \in R$, because $v_k(\cdot, z')$ is uniformly continuous on X for each $z' \in Z$ and $\delta(z, L(\cdot))$ is constant on each $r \in R$. This result, in conjunction with finiteness of $|R|$, makes v_z uniformly continuous on $X \setminus D_\epsilon$, with some modulus of continuity $\mu_{v_z,\epsilon}$ that is concave and non-decreasing. By [28], there exists a function $v'_\epsilon : X \to \mathbb{R}$ that is uniformly continuous on X, agrees with v_z on $X \setminus D_\epsilon$ and for which $\mu_{v_z,\epsilon}$ is also a valid modulus of continuity. We define $v_\epsilon \in \mathcal{V}$ as $v_\epsilon(x) := \max\{0, \min\{v'_\epsilon(x), 1\}\}$ for all $x \in X$, and note that $\mu_{v_z,\epsilon}$ is also a modulus of continuity of v_ϵ. Define also $r_\epsilon \in \mathcal{V}$ as $r_\epsilon := v_z - v_\epsilon$, which is zero on $X \setminus D_\epsilon$. Pick $a \in A$. Since $|r_\epsilon| \leq 1$, then

$$\begin{aligned}&|\mathcal{B}_a[v_k](x, z) - \mathcal{B}_a[v_k](y, z)| \leq \\ &\leq |\int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a) - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid y, a)| \\ &\leq |\int_X v_\epsilon d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a) - \int_X v_\epsilon d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid y, a)| + \\ &+ |\int_X r_\epsilon d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a) - \int_X r_\epsilon d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid y, a)| \\ &\leq |\int_X v_\epsilon d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a) - \int_X v_\epsilon d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid y, a)| + \\ &+ \mathcal{T}(D_\epsilon \mid x, a) + \mathcal{T}(D_\epsilon \mid y, a).\end{aligned}$$

By Proposition 1, $|\int_X v_\epsilon d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a) - \int_X v_\epsilon d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid y, a)| \leq \mu_{v_z,\epsilon}(L_f\|x - y\|)$. Taking also into account Assumption 2, the bound becomes

$$\begin{aligned}&|\int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a) - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid y, a)| \\ &\quad\leq \mu_{v_z,\epsilon}(L_f\|x - y\|) + 2\overline{\tau}\mathcal{L}(D_\epsilon).\end{aligned}$$

Let $\theta > 0$ and choose ϵ such that $2\overline{\tau}\mathcal{L}(D_\epsilon) \leq \theta/2$. Given that ϵ, pick $\beta > 0$ such that $\mu_{v_z,\epsilon}(L_f\|x - y\|) \leq \theta/2$ for all $\|x - y\| \leq \beta$, which is always possible since $\mu_{v_z,\epsilon}$ is a valid modulus of continuity. It is evident that for all $x, y \in X$ such that $\|x - y\| \leq \beta$ it holds that $|\int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x, a) - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid y, a)| \leq \theta$. Since such a β exists for each $\theta > 0$ and $a \in A$, we conclude that $v_{k+1}(\cdot, z)$ is uniformly continuous on X. Furthermore, this holds for each $z \in Z$. The proof is concluded by induction. □

Proof of Lemma 3. Similarly to the proof of Lemma 2, let $D_\epsilon := \cup_{r\in R}\partial r \oplus B(0, \epsilon)$. Fix $z \in Z$ and $a \in A$. Note that v_z is uniformly continuous on each $r \in R$, because $v(\cdot, z')$ is uniformly continuous on X for each $z' \in Z$ and $\delta(z, L(\cdot))$ is constant on each $r \in R$. This result, in conjunction with finiteness of $|R|$, makes v_z uniformly continuous on $X \setminus D_\epsilon$, with some modulus of continuity $\mu_{v_z,\epsilon}$ that is concave and

non-decreasing. By [28], there exists a function $v'_\epsilon : X \to \mathbb{R}$ that is uniformly continuous on X, agrees with u_z on $X \setminus D_\epsilon$ and for which $\mu_{v_z,\epsilon}$ is also a valid modulus of continuity. We define $v_\epsilon \in \mathcal{V}$ as $v_\epsilon(x) := \max\{0, \min\{v'_\epsilon(x), 1\}\}$ for all $x \in X$, and note that $\mu_{v_z,\epsilon}$ is also a modulus of continuity for v_ϵ. Define also $r_\epsilon \in \mathcal{V}$ as $r_\epsilon = v_z - v_\epsilon$, which is zero on $X \setminus D_\epsilon$. By Proposition 1 and since $|r_\epsilon| \leq 1$,

$$\begin{aligned}
&|\int_X v_z d\gamma^\eta_{x,a} - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a)| \\
&\leq |\int_X v_\epsilon d\gamma^\eta_{x,a} - \int_X v_\epsilon d\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a)| + \\
&+ |\int_X r_\epsilon d\gamma^\eta_{x,a} - \int_X r_\epsilon d\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a)| \\
&\leq \mu_{v_z,\epsilon}(\mathcal{W}(\gamma^\eta_{x,a}, \mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a))) + \\
&+ \gamma^\eta_{x,a}(D_\epsilon) + \mathcal{T}^\eta(D_\epsilon \mid x,a).
\end{aligned}$$

By soundness of $\mathcal{U}^\eta$, $\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a) \in \Gamma^\eta_{s,a}$. Since $\mathcal{W}(\gamma^\eta_{x,a}, \mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a)) \leq \mathrm{diam}_{\mathcal{W}}(\Gamma^\eta_{s,a}) \leq \phi(\eta)$. Next, we bound $\gamma^\eta_{x,a}(D_\epsilon)$. The previous result implies that there exists a coupling $\pi \in \mathcal{P}(X \times X)$ with marginals $\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a)$ and $\gamma^\eta_{x,a}$, implying that we can express $\gamma^\eta_{x,a}(D_\epsilon) = \pi(X \times D_\epsilon)$, and which has transport cost $\int_{X\times X} |x' - y'| d\pi(x',y') \leq \phi(\eta)$. Now, the event $X \times D_\epsilon$ satisfies

$$\begin{aligned}
X_{\text{abs}} \times D_\epsilon &= \{(x,y) \in X \times X : y \in D_\epsilon\} \\
&\subseteq \{(x',y') \in X \times X : x' \in D_{2\epsilon}\} \cup \\
&\cup \{(x',y') \in X \times X : |x' - y'| > \epsilon\}.
\end{aligned}$$

Therefore,

$$\gamma^\eta_{x,a}(D_\epsilon) \leq \mathcal{T}^\eta(D_{2\epsilon} \mid x,a) + \pi(\{(x',y') : |x' - y'| > \epsilon\}),$$

where Chebyshev's inequality gives us $\pi(\{(x',y') : |x' - y'| > \epsilon\}) \leq (1/\epsilon) \int_{X\times X} |x' - y'| d\pi(x',y') \leq \phi(\eta)/\epsilon$. Next, we bound $\mathcal{T}^\eta(D_{2\epsilon} \mid x,a)$. Noting that $\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a)$ and $\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x,a)$ are supported on X_{abs} and $\mathrm{diam}(b) \leq 2\eta$ for all regions $b \in B^\eta$,

$$\begin{aligned}
&\sum_{b \in B^\eta} \mathcal{T}^\eta(b \cap D_{2\epsilon} \mid x,a) = \sum_{b \in B^\eta : b \cap D_{2\epsilon} \neq \emptyset} \mathcal{T}^\eta(b \cap D_{2\epsilon} \mid x,a) \\
&\leq \sum_{b \in B^\eta : b \cap D_{2\epsilon} \neq \emptyset} \mathcal{T}^\eta(b \mid x,a) = T(\bigcup_{b \in B^\eta : b \cap D_{2\epsilon} \neq \emptyset} b \mid x,a) \\
&\leq \mathcal{T}(D_{2\epsilon+2\eta} \mid x,a) \leq \overline{\tau}\mathcal{L}(D_{2\epsilon+2\eta}).
\end{aligned}$$

Putting the previous bounds together we obtain that, for $\epsilon > 0$ small enough,

$$\begin{aligned}
&|\int_X v_z d\gamma^\eta_{x,a} - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a)| \\
&\leq \mu_{v_z,\epsilon}(\phi(\eta)) + \phi(\eta)/\epsilon + \overline{\tau}(\mathcal{L}(D_{2\epsilon+2\eta}) + \mathcal{L}(D_{\epsilon+2\eta})).
\end{aligned}$$

Let $\theta > 0$ and choose $\epsilon, \eta_0 > 0$ such that $\overline{\tau}(\mathcal{L}(D_{2\epsilon+2\eta}) + \mathcal{L}(D_{\epsilon+2\eta})) \leq \theta/2$ for all $\eta \in (0, \eta_0]$. Given that ϵ, pick $\eta'_0 \in (0, \eta_0]$ such that $\mu_{v_z,\epsilon}(\phi(\eta)) + \phi(\eta)/\epsilon \leq \theta/2$ for all $\eta \in (0, \eta'_0]$, which is always possible since $\mu_{v_z,\epsilon}$ is a valid modulus of continuity. Note that picking $\eta'_0 \leq \eta_0$ only makes the terms $\overline{\tau}(\mathcal{L}(D_{2\epsilon+2\eta}) + \mathcal{L}(D_{\epsilon+2\eta}))$ smaller. It is evident that for all $\eta \in (0, \eta'_0]$ it holds that $|\int_X v_z d\gamma^\eta_{x,a} - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a)| \leq \theta$. Since such a η'_0 exists for each $\theta > 0$ independently from $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$, we conclude that $\lim_{\eta\to 0} |\int_X v_z d\gamma^\eta_{x,a} - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a)| = 0$ uniformly in $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$. The proof is concluding by observing that $z \in Z$ and $a \in A$ were arbitrary choices. □

Proof of Lemma 4. For each $r \in R$, let $\mu_{v,z,r}$ denote a modulus of continuity of v_z over r, meaning that

$$|v_z(x') - v_z(y')| \leq \mu_{v,z,r}(\|x' - y'\|),$$

for all $x', y' \in r$. Let also $\mu_{v,z}(\eta) := \max_{r\in R} \mu_{v,z,r}(\eta)$ for all $\eta \geq 0$. Denote by $r(s') \in R$ the region of interest that contains $s' \in S^\eta$. Then, since $\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a)$ and $\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x,a)$ are supported on X_{abs},

$$\begin{aligned}
&|\int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a) - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x,a)| \\
&\leq \sum_{b \in B^\eta} \left| \mathcal{T}^\eta(b \mid x,a) \sup_{x' \in b} v_z(x') - \mathcal{T}(b \mid x,a) \inf_{y' \in b} v_z(y') \right| \\
&= \sum_{b \in B^\eta} \mathcal{T}(b \mid x,a) \sup_{x',y' \in b} |v_z(x') - v_z(y')| \\
&\leq \sum_{s' \in S^\eta} \mathcal{T}(\rho^{-\eta}(s') \mid x,a) \mu_{v,z,r(s')}(2\eta) \leq \mu_{v_z}(2\eta),
\end{aligned}$$

uniformly on $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$. Observing that $\lim_{\eta\to 0} \mu_v(2\eta) = 0$ concludes the proof. □

Proof of Lemma 5. Let $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$, $s = \rho(x)$ and $z \in Z$. Note that

$$\begin{aligned}
&|\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v](x,z) - \mathcal{B}[v](x,z)| \\
&\qquad = |\max_{a\in A} \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v](x,z) - \max_{a\in A} \mathcal{B}_a[v](x,z)|.
\end{aligned}$$

Let $a^* \in \arg\max\{\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v](x,z) : a \in A\}$. Then,

$$\begin{aligned}
&|\max_{a\in A} \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v](x,z) - \max_{a\in A} \mathcal{B}_a[v](x,z)| \\
&\qquad \leq |\underline{\mathcal{B}}^{\eta;\varphi}_{a^*}[v](x,z) - B^\varphi_{a^*}[v](x,z)| \\
&\qquad \leq \max_{a\in A} |\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v](x,z) - \mathcal{B}_a[v](x,z)|. \quad (6)
\end{aligned}$$

Therefore, it suffices to prove uniform convergence of $|\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v](x,z) - \mathcal{B}_a[v](x,z)|$ for all $a \in A$. Pick $a \in A$ and denote

$$\gamma^{\eta*}_{x,a} \in \arg\min_{\gamma \in \Gamma^\eta_{s,a}} \int_X v^\eta(\cdot, \delta(z, L(\cdot))) d\gamma.$$

Let $v_z := v(\cdot, \delta(z, L(\cdot)))$ and $v^\eta_z := v^\eta(\cdot, \delta(z, L(\cdot)))$. Then,

$$\begin{aligned}
&|\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v](x,z) - \mathcal{B}_a[v](x,z)| \\
&\qquad \leq |\int_X v^\eta_z d\gamma^{\eta*}_{x,a} - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x,a)| \\
&\qquad \leq |\int_X v^\eta_z d\gamma^{\eta*}_{x,a} - \int_X v_z d\gamma^{\eta*}_{x,a}| \\
&\qquad + |\int_X v_z d\gamma^{\eta*}_{x,a} - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a)| \\
&\qquad + |\int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a) - \int_X v_z d\mathcal{T}(\cdot \mid x,a)|. \quad (7)
\end{aligned}$$

Noting that $\gamma^{\eta *}_{x,a}$ and $\mathcal{T}^\eta(\cdot \mid x,a)$ are supported on X_{abs}, we obtain the following bound on the first term in Equation (7):

$$\begin{aligned}
&\sum_{b\in B^\eta}\int_b |v^\eta_z(x') - v_z(x')| d\gamma^{\eta *}_{x,a}(x') \\
&\leq \sum_{b\in B^\eta} |\sup_{x'\in b} v_z(x') - \inf_{x'\in b} v_z(x')| \gamma^{\eta *}_{x,a}(b) \\
&\leq \sum_{b\in B^\eta} \sup_{x',y'\in b} |v_z(x') - v_z(x')| \gamma^{\eta *}_{x,a}(b) \\
&\leq \sum_{s'\in S^\eta} \mu_{v,z,r(s')}(2\eta)\gamma^{\eta *}_{x,a}(\rho^{-\eta}(s')) \leq \mu_v(2\eta).
\end{aligned}$$

Since the previous bound holds for all $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$, the first term in (7) converges to 0 uniformly on $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$.

Next, we bound the second term in (7). Since $\phi(\eta)$ and the function $v_z \in \mathcal{V}$ satisfy the conditions of Lemma 3 and $\gamma^{\eta,*}_{x,a} \in \Gamma^\eta_{s,a}$, the second term in (7) converges to 0 uniformly on $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$.

Finally we bound the third term in (7). Since v satisfies the conditions of Lemma 4, the third term in (7) converges to 0 uniformly over $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$.

By the previous reasoning, $|\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v](x,z) - \mathcal{B}_a[v](x,z)|$ converges to 0, as $\eta \to 0$, uniformly on $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$ for all actions $a \in A$. By finiteness of A, it follows that $|\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v](x,z) - \mathcal{B}[v](x,z)|$ also converges to 0 uniformly on $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$, concluding the proof. □

Proof of Lemma 6. Pick $v, v' \in \mathcal{V}^\varphi$, $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$ and let $s = \rho(x)$. Define $v_z := v(\cdot, \delta(z, L(\cdot)))$ and $v'_z := v'(\cdot, \delta(z, L(\cdot)))$ for all $z \in Z$. Then, by (6), $|\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v](x,z) - \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v'](x,z)| \leq \max_{a\in A} |\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v](x,z) - \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v'](x,z)|$. Fix $a \in A$ and define $\gamma'^* \in \arg\min_{\gamma\in\Gamma^\eta_{s,a}} \int_X v'^\eta_z d\gamma$. Then, noting that γ'^* is supported on X_{abs}, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned}
&|\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v](x,z) - \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta_a[v'](x,z)| \\
&\leq |\int_X v^\eta_z d\gamma'^* - \int_X v'^\eta_z d\gamma'^*| \leq \sum_{b\in B^\eta}\int_b |v^\eta_z - v'^\eta_z| d\gamma'^* \\
&\leq \sum_{b\in B^\eta} \gamma'^*(b) \sup_{x'\in b} |v^\eta(x', \delta(z, L(x'))) - \\
&\qquad - v'^\eta(x', \delta(z, L(x')))|.
\end{aligned}$$

Taking into account that $\delta(z, L(x')) = z_{\text{unsafe}}$ for all $x' \notin X_{\text{safe}}$ and that $v(\cdot, z_{\text{unsafe}}) = v'(\cdot, z_{\text{unsafe}}) = 0$, the previous expression is bounded by

$$\begin{aligned}
&\sum_{b\in B^\eta} \gamma'^*(b) \sup_{x'\in X_{\text{safe}}} |v^\eta(x', \delta(z, L(x'))) - \\
&- v'^\eta(x', \delta(z, L(x')))| \leq \sup_{x'\in X_{\text{safe}}, z\in Z} |v^\eta(x', z) - v'^\eta(x', z)|.
\end{aligned}$$

Since the previous bound is uniform on $a \in A$, it is also a bound on $|\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v](x,z) - \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v'](x,z)|$. Observing that $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$ and $z \in Z$ were chosen arbitrarily concludes the proof. □

Proof of Theorem 1. Consider the RDP sequences $(v_k)_{k\leq T}, (\underline{v}^\eta_k)_{k\leq T} \subset \mathcal{V}^\varphi$ defined in Proposition 1. Since z_{unsafe} is absorbing, one can prove by induction that $v_k(\cdot, z_{\text{unsafe}}) = \underline{v}^\eta_k(\cdot, z_{\text{unsafe}}) = 0$ for all $k \leq T$. By Lemma 6,

$$\begin{aligned}
&\sup_{x\in X_{\text{safe}}, z\in Z} |v_T(x,z) - \underline{v}^\eta_T(x,z)| \\
&= \sup_{x\in X_{\text{safe}}, z\in Z} |\mathcal{B}[v_{T-1}](x,z) - \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[\underline{v}^\eta_{T-1}](x,z)| \\
&\leq \sup_{x\in X_{\text{safe}}, z\in Z} |\mathcal{B}[v_{T-1}](x,z) - \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v_{T-1}](x,z)| + \\
&+ \sup_{x\in X_{\text{safe}}, z\in Z} |\underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v_{T-1}](x,z) - \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[\underline{v}^\eta_{T-1}](x,z)| \\
&\leq \sup_{x\in X_{\text{safe}}, z\in Z} |\mathcal{B}[v_{T-1}](x,z) - \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v_{T-1}](x,z)| + \\
&\quad + \sup_{x\in X_{\text{safe}}, z\in Z} |v_{T-1}(x,z) - \underline{v}^\eta_{T-1}(x,z)| \\
&\leq \sum_{k=0}^{T-1} \sup_{x\in X_{\text{safe}}, z\in Z} |\mathcal{B}[v_k](x,z) - \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v_k](x,z)|. \quad (8)
\end{aligned}$$

Pick $\epsilon > 0$, let $k \in \{0, 1, \ldots, T-1\}$ and note that, by Lemma 5, for all $\epsilon > 0$ I can pick $\eta^0_k > 0$ small enough so that for all $\eta \in (0, \eta^0_k]$ it holds that $\sup_{x\in X_{\text{safe}}, z\in Z} |\mathcal{B}[v_k](x,z) - \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[v_k](x,z)| < \epsilon/(T-1)$. Then, by Equation (8), letting $\eta_0 := \min\{\eta^k_0 : k \in \{0, 1, \ldots, T-1\}\}$ guarantees that $\sup_{x\in X_{\text{safe}}, z\in Z} |v_T(x,z) - \underline{v}^\eta_T(x,z)| < \epsilon$ for all $\eta \in (0, \eta_0]$. Therefore, $\lim_{\eta\to 0} |v_T(x,z) - \underline{v}^\eta_T(x,z)| = 0$ uniformly in $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$ and $z \in Z$. This implies that $\underline{p}^\eta_T(x) = \underline{v}^\eta_T(x, \delta(z_{\text{init}}, L(x)))$ converges to $p_T(x) = v_T(x, \delta(z_{\text{init}}, L(x)))$ uniformly on $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$. Furthermore, note that if $x \notin X_{\text{safe}}$ it holds that $\delta(z_{\text{init}}, L(x)) = z_{\text{unsafe}}$, which implies that $p_T(x) := v_T(x, \delta(z_{\text{init}}, L(x))) = 0$ and $\underline{p}^\eta_T(x) := \underline{v}^\eta_T(x, \delta(z_{\text{init}}, L(x))) = 0$. This, together with the previous result yields $\lim_{\eta\to 0} |p_T(x) - \underline{p}^\eta_T(x)| = 0$ uniformly on X.

By a similar reasoning, we observe that the upper bound $\overline{p}^\eta_T \in \mathcal{V}^\varphi$ defined in Proposition 1 also converges uniformly to p_T. Finally, Lemma 2 gives us $P^{\kappa^\varepsilon}_{x_0}[\varphi, T] = [\underline{p}^\varepsilon(x_0), \overline{p}^\varepsilon(x_0)]$ for all $x_0 \in X$. Furthermore, soundness of the abstraction procedure ensures that $P^*_{x_0}[\varphi, T]$ also meets this bounds uniformly on $x_0 \in X$. By a similar reasoning as that of [IG: CITE JOHN: SECTION 5.1], $|P^*_{x_0}[\varphi, T] - P^{\kappa^\varepsilon}_{x_0}[\varphi, T]| \leq \overline{p}(x_0) - \underline{p}(x_0)|$ which converges to 0 uniformly on $x_0 \in X$. This concludes the proof. □

Proof of Corollary 1. The proof uses a similar reason than that of [IG: CITE JOHN: SECTION 5.1]. Note that Algorithm 1 iteratively refines the partition in such a way that $\eta_i \to 0$. By Theorem 1, the difference $\overline{p}(x_0) - \underline{p}(x_0)$ will eventually be bounded by ε uniformly on $x_0 \in X$ for some iteration number $i \in \mathbb{N}_0$, thus exiting the for loop. Next, observe that Proposition 1 gives us $P^*_{x_0}[\varphi, T], P^{\kappa^\varepsilon}_{x_0}[\varphi, T] = [\underline{p}^\varepsilon(x_0), \overline{p}^\varepsilon(x_0)]$ for all $x_0 \in X$. This implies that $|P^*_{x_0}[\varphi, T] - P^{\kappa^\varepsilon}_{x_0}[\varphi, T]| \leq \overline{p}(x_0) - \underline{p}(x_0)| \leq \varepsilon$ for all $x_0 \in X$, which concludes the proof. □

Proof of Theorem 2. Note that, by Theorem 1 and Corollary 1, the first condition implies the others, thus it suffices to prove the former condition. Pick $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$ and $a \in A$, and let $s = \rho(s)$. Let also $\gamma, \gamma' \in \Gamma^\eta_{s,a}$ which, by [IG: REF],

corresponds to the distributions $\alpha_{c_1}, \dots, \alpha_{c_{|C^\eta|}}$, supported on $q_{s,a,c_1}, \dots, q_{s,a,c_{|C^\eta|}}$ respectively. Now, for each $c \in C^\eta$, let $\pi_c^* \in \mathcal{P}(q^\eta_{s,a,c} \times q^\eta_{s,a,c})$ be the optimal coupling between α_c and α'_c. Define the coupling $\pi := \sum_{c \in C^\eta} P_W(c)\pi_c^* \in \mathcal{P}(q^\eta_{s,a,c} \times q^\eta_{s,a,c})$, and note its marginals are

$$\sum_{s_1 \in S^\eta} \pi(s_1, s_2) = \sum_{c \in C^\eta} P_W(c) \sum_{s_1 \in S^\eta} \pi_c^*(s_1, s_2) = \\ = \sum_{c \in C^\eta} P_W(c)\alpha'_c(s_2) = \gamma'(s_2) \\ \sum_{s_2 \in S^\eta} \pi(s_1, s_2) = \sum_{c \in C^\eta} P_W(c) \sum_{s_2 \in S^\eta} \pi_c^*(s_1, s_2) = \\ = \sum_{c \in C^\eta} P_W(c)\alpha_c(s_1) = \gamma(s_1),$$

for all $s, s' \in S^\eta$, which implies that π is a coupling between γ and γ'. Then, the Wasserstein distance between these two distributions is bounded by

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{W}(\gamma, \gamma') &= \int_{x_1, x_2 \in X} |x - x'| d\pi(x_1, x_2) \\ &\leq \sum_{s_1, s_2 \in S^\eta} |s_1 - s_2| \sum_{c \in C^\eta} P_W(c)\pi_c^*(s_1, s_2) \\ &\leq \sum_{c \in C^\eta} P_W(c) \sum_{s_1, s_2 \in S^\eta} |s_1 - s_2|\pi_c^*(s_1, s_2) \\ &= \sum_{c \in C^\eta} P_W(c) \sum_{s_1, s_2 \in q^\eta_{s,a,c}} |s_1 - s_2|\pi_c^*(s_1, s_2) \\ &\leq \max_{s_1, s_2 \in q^\eta_{s,a,c}, c \in C^\eta} \|s_1 - s_2\| \\ &\leq \max_{c \in C^\eta} \operatorname{diam}(\mathcal{R}(\rho^{-\eta}(s), a, c)) + 2\eta \\ &\leq (4L_f + 2)\eta. \end{aligned}$$

Note that this bound holds for all $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$ and $a \in A$, and vanishes as $\eta \to 0$. This concludes the proof. □

Proof of Theorem 3. For the sake of notation, we omit the superscript $\mathbb{S}$ and keep the dependence on η implicit. Let $(\underline{v}_k)_{k \leq T}$ and $(\overline{v}_k)_{k \leq T}$ be the sequences of value functions obtained via RDP on $\mathcal{U}^\varphi$ as per Proposition 1. Similarly, let $(\underline{v}'_k)_{k \leq T}$ and $(\overline{v}'_k)_{k \leq T}$ be the ones obtained for $\widetilde{\mathcal{U}}^\varphi$. Note that, by Proposition 1 and an induction argument, one can prove that $\underline{v}_k(\cdot, z_{\text{unsafe}}) = \overline{v}_k(\cdot, z_{\text{unsafe}}) = \underline{v}'_k(\cdot, z_{\text{unsafe}}) = \overline{v}'_k(\cdot, z_{\text{unsafe}}) = 0$ for all $k \leq T$. We first show, by induction on the sequences $(\underline{v}'_k)_{k \leq T}$ and $(\underline{v}_k)_{k \leq T}$, that $\underline{p}'_T(x) := \underline{v}_T(x, \delta(z_{\text{init}}, L(x))) = \underline{p}_T(x)$ for all $x \in X$. Fix $k \leq T$ and assume that $\underline{v}'_k(x, z) = \underline{v}_k(x, z)$ for all $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$ and $z \in Z$, which is trivially satisfied at $k = 0$. Pick $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$ and $z \in Z$, and let $s = \tilde{\rho}(x)$. Note that, by Proposition 1 and, since $\underline{v}_k$ is its own piecewise constant minorizer on the partition B,

$$\underline{v}_{k+1}(x, z) = \underline{\mathcal{B}}^\eta[\underline{v}_k](x, z) \\ = \mathbb{1}_{Z_{\text{acc}}}(z) + \mathbb{1}_{Z \setminus Z_{\text{acc}}}(z) \max_{a \in A} \min_{\gamma \in \Gamma_{s,a}} \int_X \underline{v}_k(\cdot, \delta(z, L(\cdot)))d\gamma.$$

We also obtain a similar expression for $\underline{v}'_{k+1}$ as a function of $\underline{v}'_k$. Note that if $z \in Z_{\text{acc}}$, then $\underline{v}'_{k+1}(x, z) = \underline{v}_{k+1}(x, z) = 1$. We now consider the case $z \notin Z_{\text{acc}}$. By [11, Theorem 5],

$$\begin{aligned} \underline{v}_{k+1}(x, z) &= \max_{a \in A} \min_{\gamma \in \Gamma_{s,a}} \int_X \underline{v}_k(\cdot, \delta(z, L(\cdot)))d\gamma \\ &= \max_{a \in A} \sum_{c \in C^\eta} P_W(c) \min_{s' \in q_{s,a,c}} \underline{v}_k(s', \delta(z, L(s'))). \end{aligned} \tag{9}$$

By the previous reasoning we also arrive to a similar expression for the case of $\underline{v}'_{k+1}$ as a function of $\underline{v}'_k$. Note that if a cluster $q_{s,a,c}$ of $\mathcal{U}$ contains any unsafe state $s' \in X_{\text{unsafe}}$, then, the corresponding cluster $\tilde{q}_{s,a,c}$ of $\widetilde{\mathcal{U}}$ contains s_{unsafe}. In that case, since $\delta(z, L(s_{\text{unsafe}})) = z_{\text{unsafe}}$, it follows that $\min_{s' \in q_{s,a,c}} \underline{v}_k(s', \delta(z, L(s'))) = \min_{s' \in \tilde{q}_{s,a,c}} \underline{v}'_k(s', \delta(z, L(s'))) = \underline{v}'_k(s', z_{\text{unsafe}}) = 0$. On the other hand, if $q_{s,a,c}$ does not contain any unsafe state, then $\tilde{q}_{s,a,c} = q_{s,a,c}$. These results, together with Equation (9) and the induction hypothesis, imply that $\underline{v}'_{k+1}(x, z) = \underline{v}_{k+1}(x, z)$ for all $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$ an $z \in Z$. Therefore, by induction, $\underline{v}'_k(x, z) = \underline{v}_k(x, z)$ for all $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$, $z \in Z$ and $k \leq T$. This implies that $\underline{p}'_T(x) = \underline{v}'_T(x, \delta(z_{\text{init}}, L(x))) = \underline{v}_T(x, \delta(z_{\text{init}}, L(x))) = \underline{v}_k(x)$ for all $x \in X_{\text{safe}}$. Additionally, for all $x \notin X_{\text{safe}}$, $\delta(z_{\text{init}}, L(x)) = z_{\text{unsafe}}$, which implies that $\underline{p}'_T(x) = \underline{v}'_T(x, \delta(z_{\text{init}}, L(x))) = \underline{v}_T(x, \delta(z_{\text{init}}, L(x))) = \underline{v}_T(x, z_{\text{unsafe}}) = 0$. Putting the previous results together we have that $\underline{p}'_T = \underline{p}$. A similar reasoning reveals that $\overline{p}'_T = \overline{p}_T$ Since these results hold for all partition sizes $\eta > 0$, asymptotic optimality directly follows from the reasoning in the proof of Theorem 1, and completeness of Algorithm 1 follows from Corollary 1. □

Proof of Theorem 4. The proof is by counterexample. Consider the reach-avoid specification $\varphi = \Diamond \mathfrak{p}_{\text{goal}} \wedge \Box \mathfrak{p}_{\text{safe}}$, which we seek to satisfy under $T = 1$ time steps. Informally, φ means "eventually reach the goal r_{goal} region while remaining in X_{safe}". Without loss of generality, let B^η be a uniform partition and x be an interior point of X_0. Since the partitions become finer as $\eta \to 0$, there exists $\eta_0 > 0$ such that for $\eta \in (0, \eta_0]$ it holds that $\rho^{-\eta}(x) \subseteq X_0$. Define $W_1^\eta := \{w \in W : \mathcal{R}(\rho^{-\eta}(x), a, w)) \subseteq r_{\text{goal}}\}$ and $C_1^\eta := \{c \in C^\eta : \mathcal{R}(\rho^{-\eta}(x), a, c) \subseteq r_{\text{goal}}\}$. Note that it is possible to define the partitions B^η and C^η and the system dynamics be such that $P_W(W_1^\eta) = P_W(\cup_{c \in C_1^\eta} c) = 0.5$ for all $\eta \in (0, \eta_0]$. By non-contractiveness of f and since the partition B^η is uniform, it holds that each reachable set $\mathcal{R}(\rho^{-\eta}(x), a, c)$, with $c \in C^\eta$, always intersects more than one region $b \in B^\eta$. By the first expression in (5), this implies that $\underline{P}^\eta(s, a, s') = 0$ for all $s' \in S^\eta$, where $s = \rho^\eta(x)$. By the second expression in (5), the total probability of landing in r_{goal} in one step is upper bounded by

$$\sum_{\substack{s' \in S^\eta: \\ \rho^{-\eta}(s') \cap r_{\text{goal}} \neq \emptyset}} \overline{P}^\eta(s, a, s') = \sum_{\substack{s' \in S^\eta: \\ \rho^{-\eta}(s') \cap r_{\text{goal}} \neq \emptyset}} \sum_{c \in C^\eta} P_W(c) \\ \mathbf{1}(\mathcal{R}(\rho^{-\eta}(s), a, c) \cap \rho^{-\eta}(s') \neq \emptyset). \tag{10}$$

Swapping the order of the sum operator, we observe that, for

each $c \in C^\eta$,

$$\sum_{\substack{s' \in S^\eta: \\ \rho^{-\eta}(s') \cap r_{\text{goal}} \neq \emptyset}} \mathbf{1}(\mathcal{R}(\rho^{-\eta}(s), a, c) \cap \rho^{-\eta}(s') \neq \emptyset)$$
$$= |\{s' \in S^\eta : \mathcal{R}(\rho^{-\eta}(s), a, c) \cap \rho^{-\eta}(s') \neq \emptyset \wedge \wedge \rho^{-\eta}(s') \cap r_{\text{goal}} \neq \emptyset\}|. \quad (11)$$

Note that $\rho^{-\eta}(s') \cap r_{\text{goal}}$ is equivalent to $\rho^{-\eta}(s') \subseteq r_{\text{goal}}$, as B^η is an R-respecting partition. Adding up the terms of the form (11) for all $c \in C_1^\eta$, we obtain the following lower bound on Equation (10):

$$\sum_{c \in C_1^\eta} P_W(c) |\{s' \in S^\eta : \mathcal{R}(\rho^{-\eta}(s), a, c) \cap \cap \rho^{-\eta}(s') \neq \emptyset \wedge \rho^{-\eta}(s') \subseteq r_{\text{goal}}\}|$$
$$= \sum_{c \in C_1^\eta} P_W(c) |\{s' \in S^\eta \cap \mathcal{R}(\rho^{-\eta}(s), a, c)\}|$$
$$\geq 2 \sum_{c \in C_1^\eta} P_W(c) = 2P(\cup_{c \in C_1^\eta} c) = 1.$$

It follows that the abstraction admits probability distributions $\gamma, \gamma' \in \Gamma_{s,a}^\eta$ with $\gamma(r_{\text{goal}}) = 1$ and $\gamma'(r_{\text{goal}}) = 0$. By Proposition 1, $\underline{p}_T(x) = 0$ and $\overline{p}_T(x) = 1$. Letting $\varepsilon = 0.9$, we note that $\overline{p}_T^\eta(x) - \overline{p}_T^\eta(x) > \varepsilon$, which holds for all $\eta \in (0, \eta_0]$. In consequence, we conclude that the abstraction process is not asymptotically optimal. It is also evident that Algorithm 1 never terminates, as the condition in the "while" loop is never met. Furthermore, as $\phi(\text{Abs}_{\mathbb{I}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)) \to 0$ is a sufficient condition for asymptotic optimality, absence of asymptotic optimality together with a contrapositive argument yields that $\phi(\text{Abs}_{\mathbb{I}}(\mathcal{S}, \eta)) \not\to 0$, which concludes the proof.

We remark that it is common practice to not partition the goal state and, instead, considering it as a single state in the abstraction. However, even in this case, Theorem 4 still holds, but one should adapt the proof to consider reaching the set of states for which the value function $\underline{v}_k^\eta$ is nonzero, for some $k \leq T$ big enough. Then, one could easily show that the probability of reaching this set in one time step is 0 in the worst case. By the reasoning in [13], if this is the case for a sufficient number of states, RDP would terminate early, yielding $\underline{p}_{k+1}^\eta(x_0) = 0$ and $\overline{p}_{k+1}^\eta(x_0) = 1$ for some $x_0 \in X_{\text{safe}}$. Then the conclusions in the reach-avoid counterexample would apply, thus proving the theorem. □

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